Stacey Poole, Esq., (SBN 202964)
LERNER • POOLE, LLP
535 Pacific Avenue, Second Floor
San Francisco, CA 94133
Telephone: 415-391-6000
Fax: 415-391-6011
stacey@cafamilylaw.com

Attorneys for Petitioner
STEPHEN RUSSELL

ENDORSED
FILED
Superior Court of California
County of San Francisco
JUL 09 2018
CLERK OF THE COURT
BY: KELLY DAVIES Deputy Clerk

LERNER • POOLE, LLP
ATTORNEYS AT LAW
535 PACIFIC AVENUE, 2ND FLOOR
SAN FRANCISCO, CALIFORNIA 94133-4635
(415) 391-6000
FACSIMILE: (415) 391-6011

**SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA**

**COUNTY OF SAN FRANCISCO**

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|---|---|
| In re the Matter of<br><br>Petitioner: STEPHEN RUSSELL<br><br>and<br><br>Respondent: TARA WALSH | CASE NO.: FTP-18-377425<br><br>**DECLARATION OF ABREHET TEDLA**<br><br>Date: July 10, 2018<br>Time: 1:30 p.m.<br>Dept: 404<br>Judge: Richard C. Darwin |

I, Abrehet "Abby" Tedla, declare and state:

1. My name is Abby Tedla and from March 6 of this year to very recently, I was E.V.'s [redacted] nanny and primary caregiver. I lived with Mr. Stephen Russell and Ms. Tara Walsh at their home at [redacted]

2. First, I'd like to say that I love Evie and she was very well taken care of in San Francisco. In addition to myself, Evie's father, and sometimes staff also helped with Evie. Their home was very nice and well taken care of in one of the nicest buildings in San Francisco, and Mr. Russell had retained one of the top pediatricians in the city for Evie, and Ms. Walsh as well from a concierge medical group called Private Medical.

3. Tara moved to California from New York in March of this year. I was initially hired for a one-month contract to spend nights with the baby, but that was later expanded to



Public copy: the child's legal name is shown as E.V.; a private street address is removed. Otherwise unchanged.

include much of the day too. Tara's medication prevented her from being able to take care of the baby at night, especially before Evie was able to generally sleep through the whole night. My understanding from both Mr. Russell and Ms. Walsh was that they intended to live in San Francisco going forward. Ms. Walsh purchased clothes, furniture, baby goods, changed her address, received mail, and began seeing doctors here. I was asked to continue on and I am currently on the payroll or the next 2 ½ months.

4. I have never seen Mr. Russell be abusive to Ms. Walsh in any way and I do not believe this to be his nature. I have seen Ms. Walsh regularly verbally abuse Mr. Russell, however, but Mr. Russell was always patient and kind to her. I have witnessed Ms. Walsh yell and call Mr. Russell names such as "old, fat, asshole". Due to the ongoing verbal assaults to Mr. Russell, I once asked him "how do you do it?" I have never seen someone deal so well with another person being so verbally abusive. In fact, I contacted Mr. Crutcher at times and advised him to remove Mr. Russell from the situation as I felt so bad for him.
5. Ms. Walsh told me she took prescription sleeping pills at night prior to going to bedtime and was unable to care for Evie during the night.
6. On one occasion, on 5/15/2018, I took Evie for a walk with Ms. Walsh's permission. After returning from our daily walk with Evie, Ms. Walsh was yelling and extremely irate. She accused me of trying to take her baby away. Feeling hurt, confused and afraid by her false accusations of trying to kidnap Evie, I left the apartment and started towards the elevator. Moments later, I heard through the closed door Evie screaming. Concerned for Evie's safety I rushed back to see if she was Ok. Tara said Evie had rolled off the bed accidentally. Evie had a bump and red bruise on her head and I was asked to help get the baby to the hospital. After seeing the doctor, it was determined she was fine, thankfully.
7. Ms. Walsh had been putting drugs in his drinks without his knowledge and she had asked me to lie and tell social services that he was a bad dad/person. Once Ms. Walsh

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realized I was not going to lie for her or condone her mistreatment and drugging of Mr. Russell, she began to treat me with distain and ultimately fired me. One time after I had told Mr. Russell about her drugging him, she yelled, "I hate that fucking nanny!" On one occasion she told me she was "bipolar". I regret not informing Mr. Russell right away about her putting the pills in his wine, but I did not understand exactly what was happening.

8. I commonly worked as her nanny 18-22 hours a day, seven days a week; apparently working via her computer or enjoying her free time doing other things. I have heard Mr. Russell offer to pay her to do projects for him after she complained that she did not have any money.

9. I saw her drug him on at least two occasions; however she told me and Dan Ochoa that she "did it all the time." This caused me to fear for Mr. Russell's safety and I saw the effects on those two occasions after he drank the tainted wine. It appeared to cause him to lose consciousness shortly after. Once, when Tara's friend was visiting, I threw away any open containers of food in case maybe Tara had added it to other food or drink in the house. I also told Bryan to tell Steve not to drink anything. That night I threw away the leftover food. That was the only time I threw away food. I wasn't otherwise concerned for my safety.

10. Mr. Russell gave me 3-month severance and asked that I consider helping in case of an emergency. Ms. Walsh had just then agreed to see a new Psychiatrist after another incident where she believed she saw Mr. Russell was running around with a gun, which didn't happen. When she realized that was a delusion, she called her mother and doctor who said Ms. Walsh needed an immediate medical intervention and delusions like this had happened in the past.

11. Mr. Russell seemed genuinely committed to helping Tara and was hopeful that with treatment she might get better.

12. I love Evie and only want what is best for her. She had a very good home in San Francisco and many people who cared for her. Tara was difficult, but I believe this is

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part of her mental illness, and in reality Mr. Russell does want her to get better. Mr. Russell is a good person who provided for everything Ms. Walsh and baby needed and had many close family and staff nearby. Even though Ms. Walsh fired me twice, I came back because of Evie who is the happiest baby I have ever seen in my entire life.

13. My last act for Ms. Walsh and Mr. Russell was to help Ms. Walsh and the baby visit Ms. Walsh's parents. I was not present when this happened, but I heard that in the previous two weeks, Ms. Walsh had tried to secretly leave the state first by herself and then with the baby. On the second occasion, Mr. Russell took emergency action and received a court order to keep Evie in the state until a mediation hearing. But, Mr. Russell also thought a 2-3 week break might be helpful to Ms. Walsh. So, he agreed to let her visit her parents in NY if she would agree to stay at her parents' house and return home in 2-3 weeks. Tara agreed. I flew with Ms. Walsh and the baby and saw her father pick them up at the airport. I then stayed the night in a hotel and flew back the next day.

14. Since that time, my only conversations with Tara have been pleasantries. I did not expect her to stay in NY or make the accusations she has.

15. I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct.

Dated: 7/6/2018

Abby Tedla

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